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higher alkanes are produced. This reaction is used to prepare higher alkanes with even number of carbon atoms.

for example:

$$CH_3\text{-}Br + 2Na + Br\text{-}CH_3 \xrightarrow[\text{ether}]{\text{dry}} CH_3\text{-}CH_3 + NaBr$$

methyl bromide → ethane

iii) Corey- House Mechanism

An alkyl halide and lithium di alkyl cuprate are reacted to give higher alkane.

for example:

$$CH_3CH_2Br + (CH_3)_2LiCu \longrightarrow CH_3CH_2CH_3 + CH_3Cu + LiBr$$

ethyl bromide → propane

4) Preparation of Alkanes from Grignard reagents

Halo alkanes reacts with magnesium in the presence of dry ethers to give alkyl magnesium halide which is known as Grignard reagents. Here the alkyl group is directly attached to the magnesium metal make it to behave as carbanion. So, any compound with easily replaceable hydrogen reacts with Grignard reagent to give corresponding alkanes.

for example:

$$CH_3\text{-}Cl + Mg \xrightarrow{\text{Dry ether}} CH_3MgCl$$

chloromethane → methyl magnesium bromide

$$CH_3MgCl + H_2O \longrightarrow CH_4 + Mg(OH)Cl$$

methane

Evaluate Yourself

4) Water destroys Grignard reagents why?

5) Is it possible to prepare methane by Kolbe's Electrolytic method

13.2.2 Physical Properties:

Physical Properties

physical State
Alkanes with
c_1 to c_4 - gases
c_5 to c_{17} - liquids
c_{18} and above solids
At room temperature

Solubility
- insoluble in H_2O
- Soluble in non polar solvents

Density
- Less dense than H_2O
- Float on top of H_2O

Boiling point
- Increases as carbon chain length increases
- Decreases with increases in degree of branching

1) Boiling Point and Physical state

The boiling point of continuous chain alkanes increases with increases in length of carbon chain roughly about 30°C for every added carbon atom to the chain. Being non polar, alkanes have weak Vanderwal's force which depends upon molecular surface area and hence increases with increase molecular size. We observe that with same number of carbon atoms, straight chain isomers have